The consumers have the right to be heard in legal proceedings in law courts dealing with consumer complaints.

v) Right to Seek Redressal

When any consumer has a complaint or grievance due to unfair trade practices like charging higher price, selling of poor quality or unsafe products, lack of regularity in supplying of services etc. or if he has suffered loss or injury due to defective or adulterated products, he has the right to seek remedies. He has a right to get the defective goods replaced or money refunded by the seller or dealer. He also has the right to seek legal remedies in the appropriate courts of law. This right also provides for due compensation to consumers if they have suffered a loss or are put to inconvenience due to the fault of the supplier or manufacturer.

vi) Right to Consumer Education

To prevent market malpractices and exploitation of consumers, consumer awareness and education are essentially required. For this purpose, consumer associations, educational institutions and government policy makers can provide information to consumers about

a) The relevant laws which are aimed at preventing malpractice and promoting fair practice

b) The ways in which dishonest traders and producers may try to manipulate market practices to deceive consumers

c) How consumers can protect their own interest

d) The procedure to be adopted by consumers while making complaints.

vii) Right to Live in a Healthy Environment

It is the brith right of every individual in a society to have a clean physical environment that will enhance the quality of life. The right calls for the need to protect and improve the environment for the present and future generations. It is needless to say that the hazard to clean and safe environment is increasing day by day. This right of the consumers to be ensured of clean and safe environment casts a duty on the state to prevent any danger to environment.

viii) Right to Basic Needs

The right to basic needs is the primary right of a consumer as a human being. The very survival of an individual will be jeopardized if his basic needs are not met. Right to basic needs does not merely imply a simple right to survival but also to lead a normal life of an individual.

2.7.3 Consumer Protection Act 1986 (COPRA)

It makes provision for the establishment of consumer councils and other authorities for the settlement of consumer's disputes.

In India, it is regarded as the most important law in the field of consumer protection. It led to the establishment of a widespread network of consumer forums and appellate courts all over India.

Its provisions are very comprehensive and safeguard the economic rights of consumers very effectively. This law is based on the principle of 'self-help' to protect against all kinds of exploitative and unfair dealings, such as overpricing, defective goods and

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